Soul Frontier — Setup, Design, and Build Guide

Nacho Business × Adam · Soul Frontier · 2026-09-24

Your Game: Soul Frontier

Death Must Die × Dark Souls — top-down survivors roguelite. Your game. Your name on it. The estate provides the research, the models, and the infrastructure. You build the game.

The prototype already exists at dashboard/static/games/soul_frontier/soul_frontier.html (44KB, playable in a browser). Three characters: Twin Pistols (fast/light), Shotgun-Axe (mixed/medium), and a third slot. Canvas-based rendering with HUD, death screen, level transitions.

The research brief is at memory/runs/soul_frontier_research_20260923.md. It defines the combat DNA (Dark Souls) and the game loop DNA (Death Must Die) and how they fuse.

Combat System (Dark Souls DNA)

Stamina-based. One bar governs everything: attack, dodge, block, sprint. Resource management is the core loop. Risk-reward per action.

Action	Stamina Cost	Notes
Light swing	1	Fast, low damage, can spam
Heavy swing	3	Slow, high damage, telegraphed
Dodge roll	1	i-frames, can roll THROUGH enemies
Block	stamina	NOT available (all chars)
Sprint	1/tick	Hold to move faster

Enemies telegraph their attacks. Slow, readable wind-ups. The threat you can read is the threat you can master. Death is education — every death teaches the pattern.

No auto-attack. No lock-on. No backstab. No persistent upgrades within a run. Manual movement + manual attack + dodge-roll with i-frames.

Game Loop (Death Must Die DNA)

Wave-based survival. Survive hordes, descend deeper, defeat guardians. Runs reset on death.

System	Description
God blessing system	Choose 3 gods per run, strategic blessing synergy
Character roster	Multiple heroes with distinct playstyles
Wave progression	Survive, descend, guardian fight, repeat
Death loop	Death teaches the pattern, runs reset, you get better

Between runs: persistent progression through equipment and character mastery. Within runs: everything is temporary. The tension is between building your character THIS run and learning the patterns for NEXT run.

Your AI Model (OrcaSAQ-2 27B on your 5080)

12GB, fits your 16GB VRAM, 70.0 SWE-bench, 262K context. This model can hold your ENTIRE game codebase in context and reason about it. Point Hermes at http://localhost:11434.

What to ask it:

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# Design questions: "Review my stamina system. Is the cost balance right for a souls-like?" "Design 3 enemy types for the first wave that teach dodge-rolling" "Write a Luau boss AI that telegraphs attacks before striking" # Code generation: "Write the wave spawner module in Luau for Roblox" "Implement a stamina bar UI that drains on attack and refills over time" "Create a character selection screen with 3 classes" # Debug: "My enemies are walking through walls. Here's my collision code: [paste]"
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The Gaming Research Corpus (Your Model's Library)

The estate has a gaming corpus you feed to your model so it knows game design. Load these into Hermes as context documents:

File	What It Contains
soul_frontier_research_20260923.md	Your game's design doc: combat DNA, loop DNA, fusion design
soul_frontier.html	Your playable prototype (44KB, full source)
game_design corpus/*	Design patterns from the estate's 35 games
ARISTOCRACY_LEDGER_RECEIPTS	Evidence verification methodology (for game mechanics too)

Feed these to Hermes before asking design questions. The model needs to know what you've already decided before it can help you build the next thing.

Also load the arXiv metadata index (1.6GB, all 3.15M papers) so when you ask about pathfinding algorithms, procedural generation, or roguelite design patterns, the model can find and cite the actual research papers.

Roblox Setup (PowerShell)

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# 1. Roblox Studio # Go to roblox.com/create, download and install # 2. Ollama winget install Ollama.Ollama ollama pull hf.co/OrcaRouter/OrcaSAQ-2-27B-gguf # 3. Rojo mkdir C:\tools -Force; cd C:\tools curl -L -o rojo.zip "https://github.com/rojo-rbx/rojo/releases/download/v7.7.0/rojo-7.7.0-windows-x86_64.zip" Expand-Archive rojo.zip -DestinationPath rojo $env:PATH += ";C:\tools\rojo" # 4. VS Code winget install Microsoft.VisualStudioCode code --install-extension sumneko.lua # 5. Git winget install Git.Git
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Then: rojo serve your-game.project.json. Open Roblox Studio. Connect. Build.

Free Assets

Type	Source	License
2D sprites	itch.io/game-assets/free	Various (check each)
Tilesets	opengameart.org	CC0 and CC-BY
3D models	sketchfab.com (free section)	Various
Textures	polyhaven.com	CC0
Sound effects	freesound.org	CC0
Music	freepd.com	Public domain
Fonts	fonts.google.com	Open source
GameDev OS	github.com/Scenario-Games/GameDev-OS	Open source

GameDev OS: 9 AI specialists and 64 skills for game asset generation. 2D sprites, 3D rigging, textures, skyboxes, walkable worlds, music, SFX, trailers. Wire into Hermes via ComfyUI workflows.

How You Get Paid

Roblox pays 70%. $0.0035 per Robux. Minimum payout: 30,000 Robux (~$105).

Soul Frontier is an Action/Roguelite — mid-tier earning potential. The key monetization hooks for this genre:

Item	Type	Price (Robux)	What It Does
Extra Character Slot	Game Pass	199	Unlock a 4th character
Stamina Refill	Dev Product	49	Instant stamina refill (once per wave)
Soul Doubler	Dev Product	99	2x souls for 30 minutes
The Frontier Pass	Game Pass	499	Access to deeper levels

Roguelites monetize through repeat runs. Every death = another run = another chance to buy a stamina refill or soul doubler. The death loop IS the monetization loop.

Target: 430 pass sales = first payout (~$105). With the estate's X audience driving traffic, 2-4 weeks is realistic.

Design Principles (from the corpus)

1. Death is education. Every death teaches the pattern. Difficulty is fair, never cheating.

2. Stamina is the core loop. Attack, dodge, sprint all draw from one bar. Every action is a resource decision.

3. Telegraph and punish. Enemies wind up slowly. The player reads the tell and responds. Mastery is pattern recognition.

4. The map precedes the territory. Pre-register your boss patterns, your wave compositions, your level layouts. Then build to the map.

5. The game is a tool for the player, not a substitute for the player. The system presents challenges. The player overcomes them. The game doesn't play itself.

Bibliography